

COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING, UIC

CS 361 Systems Programming (4 Credit Hours)

Spring 2026

Instructor & Course Details

Instructor:	Jakob Eriksson
Email:	jakob@uic.edu
Drop-In Office Hours:	Days/times
Drop-In Hours Location:	CDRLC 4452
Co-Instructor/TA:	Teaching Assistant or Co-Instructor Name
Email:	ta@uic.edu
Section designation(s):	Section designation(s)
Drop-In Office Hours:	Days/times
Drop-In Hours Location:	Office location or Zoom link

Course site: [Course site](#)

Students are expected to log into the course site regularly to learn about any developments related to the course, and communicate with instructors and classmates.

Course modality: [On campus]

Days/Times: [TR 3:30-4:45]

Location/Link: [TBD]

Course Information

Catalog Course Description and Prerequisite/Corequisite Statement

This course is a study of computer systems emphasizing their impact on application level programming. By the end of the class, you will have a good low-level understanding of how applications are built from source code, how processes are created from executables, and the environment that processes run in, all primarily from a Unix perspective. In addition, you will have a good familiarity with the most important tools that a systems programmer uses, including build tools, debuggers, profilers and tracers.

Prerequisite/Corequisite: CS261 pre-requisite

Growth Mindset

Course materials and assignments can be complex and challenging, but they are crucial to your intellectual and personal growth and development. There are times you may need extra help. Students who attend class consistently, complete all assignments, thoughtfully engage with feedback on work, develop good study strategies, visit the tutoring center, and contact faculty when struggling can develop a thorough understanding of the course material and ultimately succeed in the course.

Course Goals and Learning Outcomes

- Learning Outcome 1
- Learning Outcome 2
- Learning Outcome 3

Course requirement status: [Required for Computer Science majors.]

Topics overview: [Brief list of topics to be covered.]

Required and Recommended Course Materials

Required materials:

- Textbook, articles, software, access method

Recommended materials:

- Optional resources

Required Technology

This course requires the use of a standard portable computer running Linux, Mac OS or Windows.

Course Policies & Classroom Expectations

Grading Policy and Point Breakdown

Provide the list of core assignments and points or percent of total points.

- Homework: [% or points]
- Projects/Labs: [% or points]
- Exams/Quizzes: [% or points]
- Participation/Attendance: [% or points]

Final grade scale: [A, B, C, etc., with cutoffs.]

Policy for Missed or Late Work

There is no explicit accomodation for late work in this course, see grading policy.

Attendance and Participation Policy

Attendance is not taken nor required in this course.

Academic Integrity

You may use any tools or methods you see fit to learn the materials of this course and to complete assignments. This includes enlisting the help of classmates, instructors and all AI chatbots.

However, you will be evaluated on your own knowledge, through quizzes and exams.

Please review the UIC Student Disciplinary Policy for additional information.

Email Expectations

Please use Piazza for all class-related communication. For example, questions about assignments, missing quizzes, exam results, study technique, etc are all suitable for Piazza.

Course Schedule

Week	Date(s)	Topic(s) / In-Class Activities	Readings / Work Due
1	[01/12]	Processes	[Readings, assignments due]
2	[01/19]	Processes	[Readings, assignments due]
3	[01/26]	Processes	[Readings, assignments due]
4	[02/02]	I/O	[Readings, assignments due]
5	[02/09]	I/O	[Readings, assignments due]
6	[02/16]	Memory	[Readings, assignments due]
7	[02/23]	Memory	[Readings, assignments due]
8	[03/02]		[Readings, assignments due]
9	[03/09]	Midterm and Review	[Readings, assignments due]
10	[03/16]	Concurrency	[Readings, assignments due]
	03/23	SPRING BREAK	
11	[03/30]	Concurrency	[Readings, assignments due]
12	[04/06]	[Topic and activities]	[Readings, assignments due]
13	[04/13]	Diagnostic Facilities	[Readings, assignments due]
14	[04/20]	Diagnostic Facilities	[Readings, assignments due]
15	[04/27]	Bonus Topic and Final Review	[Readings, assignments due]
16	[Finals]	Final exam week	[Final due dates or exam time]

Disclaimer

This syllabus is intended to give the student guidance on what may be covered during the semester and will be followed as closely as possible. However, as the instructor, I reserve the right to modify, supplement, and make changes as course needs arise. I will communicate such changes in advance through in-class announcements on Piazza.

Accommodations

Disability Accommodation Procedures

UIC is committed to full inclusion and participation of people with disabilities in all aspects of university life. If you face or anticipate disability-related barriers while at UIC, please connect with the Disability Resource Center (DRC) at <https://drc.uic.edu>, via email at drc@uic.edu, or call (312) 413-2183 to create a plan for reasonable accommodations. To receive accommodations, you will need to disclose the disability to the DRC, complete an interactive registration process with the DRC, and provide me with a Letter of Accommodation (LOA). Upon receipt of an LOA, I will gladly work with you and the DRC to implement approved accommodations.

Religious Accommodations

Following campus policy, if you wish to observe religious holidays, you must notify me by the tenth day of the semester. If the religious holiday is observed on or before the tenth day of the semester, you must notify me at least five days before you will be absent. Please submit this form by email with the subject heading: "YOUR NAME: Requesting Religious Accommodation."